

MECHANISED STRIKE FORCE

IRON WHEELS, STEADY VOICE, HAMMER'S FALL

ASTRA MILITARUM • IMPERIUM • MECHANISED

*"The infantryman is the Imperium's foundation; the Chimera is the wagon that brings him to where the foundation must be laid. Where the line forms, the Mechanised arrives first — and arrives, with the line already formed." — *Tactica Mechanika*, codified Cadian doctrine, M37. The Mechanised Strike Force is a regiment-agnostic doctrine: any Astra Militarum force willing to commit its infantry to Chimeras can fight as one. Steel Legion's iron tide is the archetype, but Cadian shock detachments, Death Korps relief columns, and rapid-response Imperial regiments all share the same drilled rhythm — embark, advance, deliver fire, dismount, hold.*

FACTION ABILITY — VOICE OF COMMAND

Uses the canonical Astra Militarum faction ability **Voice of Command** from *Codex: Astra Militarum* (10e). Officer models issue Orders to nearby **REGIMENT** units in your Command phase, per the canonical Order list.

DETACHMENT RULE — MECHANISED DOCTRINE

Mechanised Doctrine

The line moves on tracks. The Castellan rides with his men. The auspex maps the killing ground from the gunner's cupola, not the trench.

While a friendly **Astra Militarum** Infantry unit is embarked in a friendly **Astra Militarum** Transport, that unit adds 1 to its Objective Control characteristic (modifying the Transport's OC for purposes of objective contests).

In addition, each time a friendly **Astra Militarum** Infantry unit disembarks from a Transport during your turn, until the end of that turn, ranged attacks made by models in that unit with the **[HEAVY]** ability are made at the firing model's full Ballistic Skill (i.e., the unit ignores the standard penalty for moving when firing Heavy weapons that turn).

DETACHMENT COMPOSITION

✓ **Included:** All canonical **Astra Militarum** units — Cadian, Catachan, Tempestus Scions, Ogryns, Ratlings, Sentinels, Leman Russ variants, Chimera, Hellhound, Manticore, Basilisk, Tauros, Tauros Venator, Taurox variants, and the homebrew **Infantry Platoon** datasheet (`infantry_platoon_v3_card.html`).

✓ **Recommended:** At least one **Chimera**, **Taurox**, or other Transport in the army — the Detachment Rule does nothing without something to ride in. Most lists run 2-4 Transports.

✗ **Excluded:** Knight detachments (separate force-org). Imperial Agents (cross-codex allies can be included via standard allied-detachment rules, but do not benefit from Mechanised Doctrine).

ENHANCEMENTS

Track Commander 15 pts

The bearer is as comfortable in a Chimera's cupola as any other Castellan is in a command tent. The Castellan reads the battlefield through his vehicle's auspex.

While the bearer is embarked in a Transport, that Transport's ranged weapons are made at BS 3+ (instead of BS 4+), and the Transport's unit can re-roll Hit rolls of 1 against the closest visible enemy unit. (*Astra Militarum Officer Character only*)

Veteran Crewman 10 pts

The bearer's Chimera crew has been with him for half a campaign. They know his cue for hard-left at full speed.

While the bearer is embarked in a Transport, that Transport adds 1" to its Move characteristic, and the first failed save (other than against a Mortal Wound) the Transport makes each battle round is automatically passed instead. (*Astra Militarum Officer Character only.*)

Master Vox 10 pts

A high-amplification vox-array tuned to the regiment's command channel — the Castellan's voice carries from the battlefield's far end.

The bearer can issue Orders to any friendly **Astra Militarum** unit on the battlefield (instead of being limited to range or the normal Order-target restrictions). In addition, the bearer issues 1 additional Order per Command phase. (*Astra Militarum Officer Character only.*)

Iron-Hardened Hull 20 pts

The bearer's Chimera carries the regimental colours and the regimental memory — armour layered with battle-prayer plating, decades old, scarred and rebuilt and scarred again.

While the bearer is embarked in a Transport, that Transport's Toughness characteristic is increased by 1, and the Transport has a 5+ Feel No Pain against Mortal Wounds. (*Astra Militarum Officer Character only.*)

STRATAGEMS

Mechanised Spearhead 1 CP

Mechanised Strike Force — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

The column arrived ahead of schedule. The enemy's defensive line was drawn for a different time of day.

WHEN: Pre-game, after both armies have Deployed but before the first turn begins. Use once per battle.

TARGET: One friendly Astra Militarum Transport unit and its embarked unit.

EFFECT: Redeploy that Transport (and its embarked unit) anywhere on the battlefield wholly within 18" of any battlefield edge and more than 9" from any enemy unit.

Open Hatches! 1 CP

Mechanised Strike Force — Battle Tactic Stratagem

Every man with a las-rifle to the upper hatch. We fire as we close.

WHEN: Your Shooting phase, just after a friendly Transport's embarked unit is selected to shoot using Firing Deck.

TARGET: That embarked unit.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, increase the Transport's Firing Deck characteristic by 2 (e.g., Firing Deck 2 becomes Firing Deck 4). The embarked unit may also re-roll Wound rolls of 1 from these Firing Deck attacks.

Treads Forward! 1 CP

Mechanised Strike Force — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

Push to the line. Now. The pict-feed says the line is empty in eight seconds.

WHEN: Your Movement phase, just before a friendly Astra Militarum Transport is selected to move.

TARGET: That Transport.

EFFECT: Add 3" to that Transport's Move characteristic until the end of the phase. In addition, if the Transport Advances this Movement phase, models embarked in it may still disembark this turn (in your Movement phase, after the Transport has moved).

Disembark and Fire! 1 CP

Mechanised Strike Force — Battle Tactic Stratagem

Boots hit the dust; the lascannon teams are already setting up.

WHEN: Your Shooting phase, after a friendly Astra Militarum Infantry unit that disembarked this turn is selected to shoot.

TARGET: That Astra Militarum Infantry unit.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, that unit's ranged attacks with the **[HEAVY]** ability gain the **[SUSTAINED HITS 1]** ability. (Reminder: under the Detachment Rule, Heavy weapons are already fired at full BS even though the unit moved.)

Hull-Down Defense 1 CP

Mechanised Strike Force — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

Engines off, smokers up, glaxis to the threat.

WHEN: Start of your opponent's Shooting phase, just after a friendly Astra Militarum Transport has been selected as the target of one or more attacks.

TARGET: That Transport.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, ranged attacks targeting that Transport are subject to -1 to the Wound roll, and the Transport has the **Feel No Pain 5+** ability.

Smokescreen Surge 1 CP

Mechanised Strike Force — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

Every dischargers cycle in unison — the dust line rolls forward like a wall.

WHEN: End of your Movement phase.

TARGET: All friendly Astra Militarum Transports on the battlefield.

EFFECT: Until the start of your next turn, those Transports gain the **Stealth** ability and the **Benefit of Cover**. (Cannot be used by a Transport that Advanced this turn.)

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Homebrew — 3rd Ed lineage (Codex: Armageddon, 2000) recast as a 10e regiment-agnostic detachment. The Mechanised Strike Force generalises the Steel Legion's iconic mechanised doctrine into a doctrine any Astra Militarum regiment can adopt, sidestepping the regiment-specific army-list approach of 3e-7e in favour of the modern 10e detachment idiom. It pairs naturally with the homebrew **Infantry Platoon** datasheet ([infantry_platoon_v3_card.html](#)) — the Platoon's sub-squads slot into Chimeras and benefit from the +1 OC and Heavy-fire-on-disembark perks. It also works perfectly well with canonical 10e Cadian Shock Troops, Catachan Jungle Fighters, Tempestus Scions, and any other AM Infantry. Steel Legion is the archetype but not the only user; Cadian, Death Korps, Tallarn (where the mechanisation is light skimmers/bikes rather than Chimeras), and custom regiments all fit. Per-regiment flavour (Steel Legion's specific stratagems, Tallarn's desert raids, Catachan's jungle warfare) belongs in additional faction-specific detachments to be built later.

DETACHMENT KEYWORDS

Mechanised Strike Force • Astra Militarum • Imperium